10–13 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Get Hiccups?

① You have just finished a big bowl of noodles and a cold fizzy drink. You start to chat with your grandmother when, suddenly — *hic!* Your chest jumps. You try to keep talking — *hic!* The whole family laughs. Everyone on Earth, from a baby in a cradle to a grandfather of eighty, has had the same funny experience. **But what exactly is a hiccup, and why does the body do such a strange thing?**

② To understand hiccups, we need to meet an important muscle called the **diaphragm**. It is a large, flat, dome-shaped muscle sitting just below your lungs, like a soft, rubbery floor. When you breathe in, the diaphragm pulls down and the lungs fill with air; when you breathe out, the diaphragm rises and air leaves the lungs. You breathe like this, without thinking, about 15 to 20 times every minute.

③ A hiccup is what happens when this normally calm muscle **suddenly jumps**. The brain sends a sharp, wrong signal. The diaphragm pulls down very fast, and you take in a big, unplanned gulp of air. At the same moment, the small flap at the top of your windpipe, called the **epiglottis**, snaps shut to protect the airway. The air hits the closed flap — and makes that sharp, famous sound: *hic!*

④ So why does the brain send this wrong signal? Scientists have found several common triggers:

- **Eating too fast**, which fills the stomach with both food and air.
- Drinking **fizzy drinks**, which release lots of gas inside the stomach.
- **Sudden changes in stomach temperature** — for example, cold ice cream after a hot bowl of soup.
- **Excitement, stress, or laughing hard**, which can confuse the nerves near the diaphragm.
- **Swallowing too much air** while chewing gum or talking and eating at the same time.

All of these stretch or disturb the nerves running past the diaphragm, and a short nerve storm triggers the jump.

⑤ Most hiccups last only a few minutes. But occasionally a hiccup attack lasts much longer. The world record, held by an American farmer named Charles Osborne, is **68 years**. Yes — sixty-eight. He hiccupped while slaughtering a pig in 1922 and did not fully stop until 1990. Doctors believe he damaged a small part of his brain that controls the diaphragm. Cases this long, however, are extremely rare.

⑥ You have probably been told many "magic cures" for hiccups: **hold your breath for ten seconds, drink a glass of cold water upside-down, let a friend scare you from behind.** Do these work? Partly. All of them have one secret goal: to raise the level of **carbon dioxide** in your blood, or to calm the nerves near the diaphragm. When the nerves reset, the hiccups usually stop. Scientists say no single cure works for everyone. The most reliable method is also the dullest: **take slow, steady, careful breaths for a minute** and wait.

⑦ Why did evolution leave us with hiccups at all? A leading theory is that hiccups are a **leftover from our very distant past**. Tiny babies still in the mother's body hiccup many times a day. Some scientists believe the action helps baby lungs practise breathing before birth. Other scientists trace the reflex even further back, to ancient fish-like ancestors that used a similar muscle movement to push water over their gills. If so, hiccups are a small, silly, lovable **fossil** inside every modern human — millions of years old.

⑧ So the next time the dinner table erupts in laughter at your little *hic*, take a slow deep breath, smile, and remember: you are not just making a funny noise. You are briefly repeating a very, very old trick of life itself.

注释： diaphragm 膈肌；epiglottis 会厌软骨；fizzy drink 碳酸饮料；carbon dioxide 二氧化碳；fossil 化石

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Which muscle is most directly responsible for hiccups?

A. The heart.
B. The tongue.
C. The diaphragm — a large, flat, dome-shaped muscle sitting just below the lungs.
D. The leg muscles.

2. According to Paragraph 3, what produces the famous "hic!" sound?

A. The sound of the stomach rolling.
B. The diaphragm suddenly pulls down, a big gulp of air rushes in, and the epiglottis snaps shut, so the air hits a closed flap and makes the sharp sound.
C. The lungs quickly exploding.
D. The heart beating very fast.

3. Which of the following is NOT listed in the article as a common trigger for hiccups?

A. Eating too fast.
B. Cold ice cream right after hot soup.

C. Drinking fizzy drinks.
D. Sleeping for twelve hours.

4. What was special about the American farmer Charles Osborne?

A. He never got any hiccups.
B. His hiccup attack lasted for 68 years, from 1922 to 1990, probably because a small part of his brain was damaged.
C. He invented a cure for hiccups.
D. He hiccupped only once in his life, on his wedding day.

5. Which idea best explains why humans still have hiccups, according to the article?

A. Hiccups are a modern invention of the past ten years.
B. Hiccups are caused by Wi-Fi signals.
C. Hiccups are probably a "leftover" from our distant past — possibly helping unborn babies practise breathing, or inherited from ancient fish-like ancestors that pushed water over their gills.
D. Hiccups are a sign of illness and everyone with hiccups must see a doctor.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "muscle called the diaphragm. It is a large, flat, dome-shaped muscle sitting just below your lungs"
【解析】打嗝直接源自膈肌。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "diaphragm pulls down very fast ... epiglottis snaps shut ... The air hits the closed flap — and makes that sharp, famous sound: hic!"
【解析】两动作合成 hic 声。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段列出五条触发因素；睡十二小时未被列入
【解析】A、B、C 均被列入。D 未出现。故选 D。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第⑤段 "The world record ... Charles Osborne, is 68 years ... began in 1922 ... did not fully stop until 1990 ... damaged a small part of his brain"
【解析】68 年吉尼斯纪录。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑦段 "hiccups are a leftover from our very distant past ... help baby lungs practise breathing ... ancient fish-like ancestors ... water over their gills."
【解析】进化遗留说。A、B、D 均非科学解释。故选 C。